# Practice workbook · Mindsets and praise (Dweck; Gunderson et al., 2013)

Fixed and growth mindsets, effort versus ability praise, and the Gunderson et al. praise study.

11 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 10 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-DEV-03

# 1. Question 2 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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**2** Emily is trying to solve a maths puzzle given by her teacher. She is struggling to get the solution. Martha is a teaching assistant who is sitting with Emily and wants to encourage Emily to develop a growth mindset. Emily is trying to solve the puzzle again.

Explain **one** way that Martha could praise Emily to try to encourage a growth mindset.

You should refer to growth mindset in your answer.

**(Total for Question 2 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 2. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**2** Malik and Ruhi are trying to solve a puzzle. After every attempt, Malik is told that he has high intelligence. After every attempt, Ruhi is told that she must try harder and not give up.

(a) State, according to Carol Dweck's mindset theory, which type of mindset Malik is most likely to develop.

**(1)**

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.....

(b) State, according to Carol Dweck's mindset theory, which type of mindset Ruhi is most likely to develop.

**(1)**

.....

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**(Total for Question 2 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

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## 3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

**2** Malik and Ruhi are trying to solve a puzzle. After every attempt, Malik is told that he has high intelligence. After every attempt, Ruhi is told that she must try harder and not give up.

(a) State, according to Carol Dweck's mindset theory, which type of mindset Malik is most likely to develop.

**(1)**

.....

.....

(b) State, according to Carol Dweck's mindset theory, which type of mindset Ruhi is most likely to develop.

**(1)**

.....

.....

**(Total for Question 2 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 4. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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**1** Carol Dweck used the terms 'fixed mindset' and 'growth mindset' as part of her theory.

(a) State what is meant by a 'fixed mindset'.

**(1)**

(b) State what is meant by a 'growth mindset'.

**(1)**

**(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 5. Question 1 · part b · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS ARE

**1** Carol Dweck used the terms 'fixed mindset' and 'growth mindset' as part of her theory.

(a) State what is meant by a 'fixed mindset'.

**(1)**

(b) State what is meant by a 'growth mindset'.

**(1)**

**(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 6. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**4** Two P.E. teachers motivate their pupils differently in their lessons. The assistant head teacher wants to see how this affects the number of times each pupil attempts to break the school records in athletics.

Mr Kirkman praised pupil effort when they were running the 100m and doing the long jump. Mr Moakler praised pupil ability when they were running the 1500m and doing the high jump.

Each pupil was allowed a maximum of 10 attempts to try to break the school record for each event. The assistant head teacher measured the average number of attempts each pupil made to beat the school records.

**Figure 1** shows the findings.

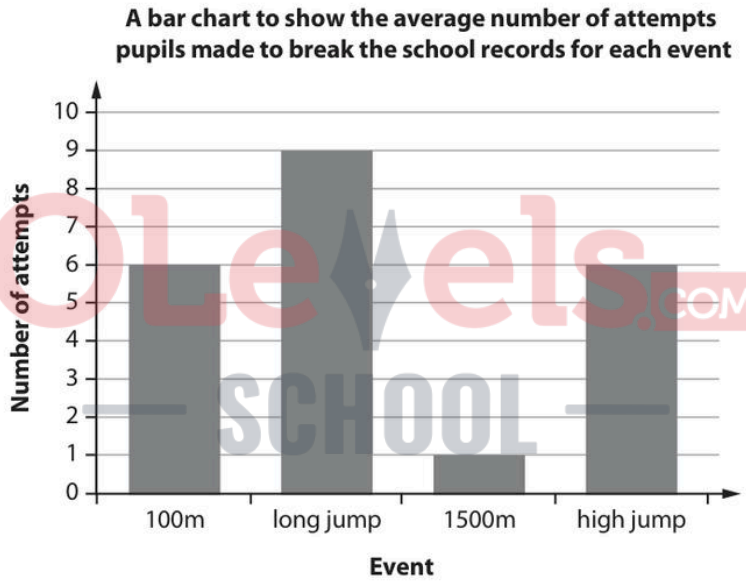



**Figure 1**

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## 6. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(a) Explain **one** conclusion you could make using the data in **Figure 1** regarding the type of praise given by each of the P.E. teachers.

**(2)**

(b) Explain **one** improvement that the assistant head teacher could make to her investigation into the influence of types of praise.

**(2)**

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**(Total for Question 4 = 4 marks)**

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## 6. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 7. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**2** (a) Identify the age of the children when being video recorded with their parents as part of the study by Gunderson et al. (2013).

**(1)**

- ☒ **A** 14 months, 22 months, 30 months
- ☒ **B** 14 months, 18 months, 38 months
- ☒ **C** 14 months, 26 months, 34 months
- ☒ **D** 14 months, 26 months, 38 months

(b) Identify which parental comment from Gunderson et al. (2013) is an example of process praise.

**(1)**

- ☒ **A** 'You must have tried hard'
- ☒ **B** 'Good girl'
- ☒ **C** 'You're so smart'
- ☒ **D** 'Wow'

**(Total for Question 2 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 8. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

**2** (a) Identify the age of the children when being video recorded with their parents as part of the study by Gunderson et al. (2013).

**(1)**

- ☒ **A** 14 months, 22 months, 30 months
- ☒ **B** 14 months, 18 months, 38 months
- ☒ **C** 14 months, 26 months, 34 months
- ☒ **D** 14 months, 26 months, 38 months

(b) Identify which parental comment from Gunderson et al. (2013) is an example of process praise.

**(1)**

- ☒ **A** 'You must have tried hard'
- ☒ **B** 'Good girl'
- ☒ **C** 'You're so smart'
- ☒ **D** 'Wow'

**(Total for Question 2 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 9. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**4** Sara is at home with her father. She is trying to read a book given to her by her teacher but is finding a lot of the words difficult to read. Sara stops reading after the first page and says to her father that there is no point continuing as she will never understand the words.

Later, Sara is trying to help her father by doing some digging in the garden. Her father had previously told her that she was good at digging. However, when the digging becomes difficult, Sara stops and goes inside the house.

(a) Explain what Sara choosing to stop reading and digging shows about her mindset.

You should refer to Carol Dweck's mindset theory in your answer.

**(2)**

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## 9. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Carol Dweck's mindset theory to account for Sara choosing to stop reading and digging.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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**(Total for Question 4 = 6 marks)**

## 9. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 10. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

**4** Sara is at home with her father. She is trying to read a book given to her by her teacher but is finding a lot of the words difficult to read. Sara stops reading after the first page and says to her father that there is no point continuing as she will never understand the words.

Later, Sara is trying to help her father by doing some digging in the garden. Her father had previously told her that she was good at digging. However, when the digging becomes difficult, Sara stops and goes inside the house.

(a) Explain what Sara choosing to stop reading and digging shows about her mindset.

You should refer to Carol Dweck's mindset theory in your answer.

**(2)**

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## 10. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Carol Dweck's mindset theory to account for Sara choosing to stop reading and digging.

**(4)**

Strength

Weakness

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**(Total for Question 4 = 6 marks)**

## 10. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 11. Question 1 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

**1** Identify **two** findings from Gunderson et al. (2013).

- ☒ **A** Boys received more process praise than girls.
- ☒ **B** Praise of any type was on average 8% of all utterances by parents.
- ☒ **C** Person praise at 14–38 months was significantly correlated to children's entity (fixed) motivational framework at 7–8 years old.
- ☒ **D** Boys received more person and other praise than girls.
- ☒ **E** Process praise at 14–38 months was significantly correlated to incremental (malleable) motivational framework at 7–8 years old.

**(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

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